AHMED ESSAM

SOC ANALYST (L1)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

SOC Analyst (L1) with 1+ year of hands-on experience in security monitoring and 8+ years in enterprise IT support and network infrastructure. Experienced in SIEM alert triage, firewall and Windows log analysis, network traffic analysis, and incident escalation through ticketing workflows. Skilled in applying the MITRE ATT&CK; framework, TCP/IP troubleshooting, Active Directory administration, and Python-based security automation. Brings strong troubleshooting discipline and a security-first mindset to protecting enterprise environments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations: SIEM Monitoring, Alert Triage, Incident Response, Log Analysis, MITRE ATT&CK;, Windows Event Log Analysis, IOC Analysis, Threat Detection
SIEM Platforms: Splunk, IBM QRadar, Wazuh
Security Tools: Wireshark, Nmap, Burp Suite
Firewalls: Palo Alto Networks, Sophos, Fortinet
EDR: CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint
Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VPN, MPLS, Firewalls, Routers, Switches, LAN/WAN, Packet Inspection
Systems: Windows Server, Active Directory, Linux, Windows Endpoints
Programming / Automation: Python (Security Automation), Bash, LangChain, Ollama (local LLM integration)
Certifications & Training: Cisco CCNA (Routing & Switching), TryHackMe SOC Level 1 Path

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SOC Analyst (L1) | Oct 2025 – Present
IP Protocol | *Cairo, Egypt*

- Monitored security alerts in the SIEM, triaging events by severity and escalating confirmed incidents to L2.
- Investigated suspicious activity across firewall, Windows endpoint, and authentication logs; documented findings and IOCs.
- Mapped detections to MITRE ATT&CK and followed incident response playbooks.
- Tracked and closed cases in the ticketing system within SLA targets.

Security Operations & IT Support | May 2020 – Sep 2025
Proper Business Solutions | *Cairo, Egypt*

- Monitored firewall logs and security events daily, triaging alerts and investigating suspicious network activity to contain anomalous behavior and escalate confirmed incidents.
- Analyzed Windows endpoint and authentication logs to detect anomalies, identify indicators of compromise, and support root-cause analysis.
- Managed end-to-end incident handling through ticketing: triage, prioritization, escalation, and documentation, within SLA targets.
- Investigated and resolved LAN/WAN, VPN, DNS, and firewall issues, reducing downtime and limiting security exposure.
- Supported security compliance by maintaining system configurations and access controls in an Active Directory environment.

Enterprise Technical Support | Nov 2017 – May 2020
WE (Telecom Egypt) | *Cairo, Egypt*

- Troubleshot enterprise VPN, MPLS, and leased-line connectivity issues for large business accounts.
- Performed network traffic analysis and packet inspection to isolate and resolve connectivity and security problems.
- Handled incident resolution and threat reporting through enterprise ticketing systems, ensuring accurate escalation and documentation.

HANDS-ON EXPERIENCE – SPLUNK SIEM

- Performed alert triage and event investigation using Splunk SPL queries across firewall, endpoint, and authentication logs.
- Built correlation searches, dashboards, and alerts in Splunk to detect anomalous activity and support incident response workflows.
- Practiced log ingestion, field extraction, and data normalization in Splunk through hands-on labs (TryHackMe SOC Level 1 path).

CYBERSECURITY PROJECTS & PRACTICAL LABS

Autonomous SOC Security Agent — AI-Powered Log Analysis Tool | May 2026
Python, LangChain, Ollama | *GitHub Repository*

- Developed an AI-assisted tool for parsing security logs and generating automated incident reports.
- Integrated LangChain with local LLMs to streamline threat analysis and recommendation workflows.

TryHackMe Cybersecurity Portfolio — SOC Level 1 Learning Path | Nov 2025 – Present
Hands-on Security Labs | *Portfolio*
- Completed the SOC Level 1 learning path, covering practical labs in alert triage, log analysis, and incident response.
- Analyzed Windows Event Logs, mapped adversary behaviors using MITRE ATT&CK, and performed IOC analysis.
- Built Python automation scripts for security utility tasks and vulnerability discovery.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Communication Engineering | Aug 2012 – May 2017
Misr Higher Institute for Engineering and Technology | *Mansoura, Egypt*
- Graduation Project: Implementation of Voice over IP (VoIP) using Cisco CUCM — Grade: Excellent.

LANGUAGES

Arabic — Native | English — Intermediate